MUSIC

# *A Score for the Ages*

**THE SYMPHONY ORCHESTRA OF INDIA IS CELEBRATING ITS 20TH YEAR WITH A DYNAMIC AUTUMN CONCERT SERIES**

The Symphony Orchestra of India (SOI) marks its 20th anniversary this year with its Autumn 2026 Season at Mumbai's National Centre for the Performing Arts (NCPA), running from August 16 to 30. Featuring four symphonic concerts and two chamber recitals, the season features chief conductor Martyn Brabbins, conductor Alessandro Bonato and soloists Annelien Van Wauwe, Francesca Dego and Bryan Cheng in programmes ranging from Beethoven and Mozart to Richard Strauss, Wagner and Tchaikovsky.

Founded in 2006 by NCPA chairman Khushroo N. Suntook and violinist Marat Bisengaliev, the SOI is India's only professional orchestra. "When we established the orchestra, there was a remit from our council, and particularly Dr



**STRINGS ATTACHED** The SOI, conducted by Martyn Brabbins, performed at the Jamshed Bhabha Theatre at NCPA, Mumbai, in February 2026




***SMALL IS BIG*** *The audience at a previous edition of BISFF in Bengaluru*

CINEMA

# **LONG STORY** SHORT

**THE BENGALURU INTERNATIONAL SHORT FILM FESTIVAL** RETURNS WITH AI, DANCE FILMS AND STORIES THAT MATTER

**The 16th edition of the Bengaluru International Short Film Festival (BISFF) will be held this August at venues such as SUCHITRA, Jain Knowledge Academy, Indian Heritage Academy and Alliance Française de Bangalore. This year, the Oscar-qualifying festival received more than 3,300 submissions from 100+ countries. "We saw a lot of films dealing with war and its aftermath, stories centred around children, and narratives exploring crime and morality," says festival director Anand Varadaraj.**

**Highlights include *La Ligne de vie* by Hugo Becker, *La Hora Escrita* by Coke Arijo, *Round and Round* by Hayato Otogi, Arun Fulra's *Hudke ki Pyaang Pyaang*, *Dhol ki Ghamaika, Bandini* by Deepti Chawla and *Aasmani* by Sayani Gupta.**

**The most interesting additions this year are 'AI–Machine Made Movies' and 'Dancing Lens'. "AI is already changing the way films are being made, whether it's writing, visual design or editing. We felt it was the right time to acknowledge that shift," says Varadaraj. The new dance film section, he adds,**